

LW566A: FINANCIAL STATEMENT ANALYSIS: BRIDGING FINANCE AND LEGAL INSIGHT

Effective Term
Semester A 2026/27

Part I Course Overview

Course Title
Financial Statement Analysis: Bridging Finance and Legal Insight

Subject Code
LW - Law

Course Number
566A

Academic Unit
School of Law (FL)

College/School
School of Law (FL)

Course Duration
One Semester

Credit Units
1.5

Level
P5, P6 - Postgraduate Degree

Medium of Instruction
English

Medium of Assessment
English

Prerequisites
LW5602A Law of Contract I or equivalent. Some courses under this intensive seminar may have specific pre-requisite. Students should refer to the individual course information for details.

Part II Course Details

Abstract
Please refer to LW566 Intensive Seminar

Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)

CILOs		Weighting (if app.)	DEC-A1	DEC-A2	DEC-A3
1	Describe and explain the basic concepts and principles related to the given seminar			x	

2	Apply the concepts and principles to solve hypothetical or real situations			x	x
3	Communicate ideas, arguments or advice clearly and coherently both orally and in writing		x	x	x
4	Critically analyse and evaluate concepts, principles and policy underpinning the area of law covered by the seminar		x	x	x

A1: Attitude

Develop an attitude of discovery/innovation/creativity, as demonstrated by students possessing a strong sense of curiosity, asking questions actively, challenging assumptions or engaging in inquiry together with teachers.

A2: Ability

Develop the ability/skill needed to discover/innovate/create, as demonstrated by students possessing critical thinking skills to assess ideas, acquiring research skills, synthesizing knowledge across disciplines or applying academic knowledge to real-life problems.

A3: Accomplishments

Demonstrate accomplishment of discovery/innovation/creativity through producing /constructing creative works/new artefacts, effective solutions to real-life problems or new processes.

Assessment Tasks / Activities (ATs)

ATs	CILO No.	Weighting (%)	Remarks	Allow Use of GenAI?
1 Sit-down assessment / or other requirement specified by course lecturer	1, 2, 3, 4	100	Good attendance (normally 75% plus)	No

Continuous Assessment (%)

100

Assessment Rubrics (AR)**Assessment Task**

Attendance and class participatio

Criterion

Demonstration of preparation for tutorial problems and other exercises.

Demonstration of ability and willingness to answer questions in tutorials and to participate in group discussion.

Demonstration of oral presentation skills and willingness.

Pass (P)

Excellent: Strong evidence of original thinking; good organization, capacity to analyse and synthesize; superior grasp of subject matter; evidence of extensive knowledge base.

Good: Evidence of grasp of subject, some evidence of critical capacity and analytic ability; reasonable understanding of issues; evidence of familiarity with literature.

Fair: Student who is profiting from the university experience; understanding of the subject; ability to develop solutions to simple problems in the material.

Marginal: Sufficient familiarity with the subject matter to enable the student to progress without repeating the course.

Failure (F)

Little evidence of familiarity with the subject matter; weakness in critical and analytic skills; limited, or irrelevant use of literatu

Assessment Task

Sit-down assessment / or other requirement specified by the course lecturer

Criterion

Demonstration of understanding of concepts, principles, and theories.

Demonstration of ability to identify legal issues.

Application of knowledge to specific legal problems, to discuss questions, and to comment on legal phenomenon.

Application of legal writing and research skills.

Demonstration of ability to engage in argument-based analysis based on critical thinking.

Demonstration of aptitude for formulating innovative solutions to designated fact-based questions.

Pass (P)

Excellent: Strong evidence of original thinking; good organization, capacity to analyse and synthesize; superior grasp of subject matter; evidence of extensive knowledge base.

Good: Evidence of grasp of subject, some evidence of critical capacity and analytic ability; reasonable understanding of issues; evidence of familiarity with literature.

Fair: Student who is profiting from the university experience; understanding of the subject; ability to develop solutions to simple problems in the material.

Marginal: Sufficient familiarity with the subject matter to enable the student to progress without repeating the course.

Failure (F)

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Part III Other Information

Keyword Syllabus

At first glance, accounting and financial statements may seem unrelated to legal practice. Yet in today's complex business environment, financial literacy is not just valuable—it's often indispensable. Whether you pursue a career as a solicitor or barrister, understanding financial principles will empower you to advise clients with greater authority, particularly when handling high-stakes transactions, disputes, or regulatory matters.

This course invites law students and professionals with little to no financial background to delve into the core elements of accounting fundamentals and financial statement analysis and understand its impact on legal decision-making.

Participants will explore how to interpret balance sheets, income statements, and cash flow statements, uncovering crucial essential insights related to legal disputes involving financial matters and corporate health, risk assessment through financial due diligence in M&A activities. Additionally, the course will address financial integrity in cases of fraud or white-collar crime and financial integrity. The curriculum emphasizes the real-world case studies and practical application of key ratios and financial metrics, enabling students to start with fundamental concepts, gradually progress to more advanced topics and equipping them with the analytical tools needed to navigate the intersection of law and finance that inform strategic decisions and regulatory compliance.

If you aspire to be a lawyer seeking a competitive edge in corporate or litigation practice; a legal professional aiming for comprehensive financial fluency for client advisory work; or someone interested in the critical role of financial analysis, join us to refine your expertise at the crossroads of law and finance—and become a more strategic and well-rounded legal professional.

Pass/Fail Grade only

1. Good attendance (normally 75% plus)

2. Sit down assessment / or other or other requirement specified by course lecture

Reading List